

The Basics

Unbound is a system designed with a top-down approach to character limitations, meaning the potential ceiling is limitless. With enough experience and imagination a character may find solutions that seem game-breaking. Unbound is designed for all types of people. Most mechanics are simple enough for casual players, especially with GM help, but some mechanics, like flight and crafting, are meant to simulate reality and are inevitably complex. Most complex systems turn into fairly simple math once worked through, but try not to overwhelm yourself with systems you may not need to use.

Character Stats and Skills

Players act as the soul of their character. Characters are born into this world with bodies that create their physical anchor, which comes with genetics or some other soul-bonding agent. To be sentient one must develop or have been given a Mind that remembers the world. The spirit is the energy that connects the mind and body influencing reaction speed and perception. The system is balanced so that a 1 is below average and 5 is a world class athlete or thinker.

Character Rating (CR) helps determine the likelihood of victory.

CR Formula: $BDY \text{ Rank} + SPT \text{ Rank} + MND \text{ Rank} + \text{Skills Value}$.

Skills Value: all current Skill Levels added together divided by 5. Round up.

A Sword Proficiency Level 2, Heavy Armor Proficiency Level 2, and Shield Proficiency Level 1 would be a Skills Value of 5 divided by 5.

Each Stat has a Stat Rank which dictates a character's d6 dice pool. All actions taken requiring a roll use a Stat Rank worth of dice. The Stat used is determined by the Skills requirements, or if no requirement is present it uses the highest Stat among the three Stats: Body (BDY), Spirit (SPT), and Mind (MND).

Example: A BDY Stat Rank of 3 would make an attack using BDY roll 3d6 when attacking.

Record XP as saved when gained and "spend" XP by subtracting XP from Saved and adding them to Total Experience (TXP). Spend XP to gain Stat Ranks, Skill Levels, Personas, and Racial Abilities. Any Rank or Level up must occur one at a time. If going from a skill Level 2 up to a Level 4 with that big boss XP score, would cost 7. Rank 2 to 3 costs 3, and 3 to 4 cost 4. 3 plus 4 is 7. If a character has saved up 7 XP then they may buy them one after another; in narrative terms "skipping a tier".

Stat Ranks start at 1. The XP cost for each increase in Stat Rank, a Rank Up, is the current Rank multiplied by the next Rank of that Stat. A character's selected Persona at creation grants a free Rank Up of +1 to one Stat based on the Persona chosen. This Persona Stat bonus is applied before any XP can be spent on a Stat Rank, effectively producing a single Rank 2 Stat on start.

Stat advancement

Baseline: Stats begin at 1.

Persona: Apply the free +1 Persona Stat **before spending** XP.

XP Cost to increase Stat Rank (R) from $R \rightarrow R+1$ is $R \times (R+1)$.

Examples: $1 \rightarrow 2$: 2 | $2 \rightarrow 3$: 6 | $3 \rightarrow 4$: 12 | $4 \rightarrow 5$: 20.

A character spends 1XP to gain a Level (L) 1 Skill with satisfied requirements. To Level Up a Skill spend XP equal to the next Level being gained. L1 to L2 costs 2 XP. L2 to L3 costs 3 XP. Going from L2 to L4 costs 7 XP. A skill can not Level Up if its Level would become higher than the Stat Rank of the Stat required to learn that skill. If no specific Stat is required then the Skill can not Level Up beyond the character's highest Stat Rank.

Skill advancement

The cost to raise a Skill from $L1 \rightarrow L2$ is **$L+1$** (the new rank).

Examples: $0 \rightarrow 1$: 1 | $1 \rightarrow 2$: 2 | $2 \rightarrow 3$: 3 | $3 \rightarrow 4$: 4 | $4 \rightarrow 5$: 5.

Advanced: When a character wishes to Rank Up a Stat to 6 or higher (god tiers), the other two Stats must be no less than 2 from the new stat. I.e. to go from 5 to 6 in BDY both SPT and MIND must be 4. Going to 7 the other two must be 5. For context, Rank 1 is an average stat for normal people while Rank 5 is an Olympic winning athlete or world class thinker. Only the top few % of mortals reach Rank 5. Rank 6 is the power of a Demi-God, 7 a lesser god, 8 a greater god, 9 a titan, and 10 is reaching beyond the universe. A character with all 10's is ready to create their own new universe in the void.

Body (BDY)	Spirit (SPT)	Mind (MND)
BDY represents strength and endurance granting movement speed.	SPT represents awareness and reaction speed granting more AP.	MND represents knowledge and foresight granting more range.
A negative in this Stat forces the character prone and unable to lift their body weight.	A negative in this Stat paralyzes the character.	A negative in this Stat is total amnesia and characters with MND 0 can not read or write.
Improves HP, HPR, and Speed	Improves SP, SPR, and AP	Improves MP, MPR, and

Resources

Health Points (HP): Represent how resilient one's body is.
Stamina Points (SP): Represent how much energy one has.
Mental Points (MP): Represent how much focus one has.
HP, SP, and MP have Regeneration Rates noted as HPR, SPR, and MPR.
Action Points (AP): Represent how quick one is.
Defense Tokens (DT): Represent reactivity.
Saved Experience (XP): Represents the potential to learn.
Total Experience (TXP): Represents knowledge gained.
Character Level (CL): Represents average Power Range of the Character

Player Resources

Core Stats

BDY (Body) HP, HPR, Speed, Block

SPT (Spirit) SP, SPR, AP, Dodge

MND (Mind) MP, MPR, x-factor, Deflect

- $XP \text{ to Stat Up} = \text{Old Rank} \times \text{New Rank}$
- $XP \text{ to Skill Up} = \text{New Level}$
- $\text{Skill Level} \leq \text{Governing Stat}$

Resource Pool

Resource Pools grow as Skills are Leveled Up.

- **HP:** Base 8 + BDY Rank.
- **HPR:** Base BDY Rank.

- **SP:** Base 8 + SPT Rank.
 - **SPR:** Base SPT Rank.
 - **MP:** Base 8 + MND Rank.
 - **MPR:** Base MND Rank.
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Round Structure

Combat Starts

1. Determine Combatant Awareness and if there is a Surprise Round.
 - a. Awareness Value is SPT roll + MND roll. To be aware, the Awareness Value must exceed 6, or the Stealth Value of the opponent.
 - b. Stealth Value is BDY roll + SPT roll.
 - c. Once Awareness Value and Stealth Value are calculated they remain the same for one minute, or 15 combat rounds, unless something requires a reroll.
2. If in a surprise round, this counts as Round 0 and characters have half AP rounded up. Only Aware characters may act in the surprise round.
3. All Characters get one turn in order of initiative. Each Turn

Rounds (One Round = 4 Seconds)

1. Calculate Initiative. Resolve ties.
 - a. Initiative Value is equal to AP generated + bonuses from skills.
 - b. Ties are resolved by adding all Stat Ranks together, highest goes first. If all the sum of Stat Ranks is tied, roll SPT until the tie is broken.
 - c. At the beginning of the round, the character with the highest initiative acts first followed by the second highest, then third highest and so on.
 - d. If an ability would change the initiative order, and a Character would be moved higher than the current Character's turn, they take their turn immediately after that Character's turn but is noted in the initiative order as the changed value.
2. Character Turns
 - a. Upkeep Phase
 - i. Clear AP and DT. Gain AP. $AP = 3 + SPT - (\text{Armor Penalty} - BDY)$.
 - ii. Regenerate pools: Gain HP equal to HPR, SP equal to SPR, and MP equal to MPR.
 - iii. Process Status Effects that trigger during Upkeep
 - b. Action Phase
 - i. Move Action: 1 AP, 1 SP. Move up to Speed spaces.
 - ii. Use an ability. The ability will dictate AP and resource costs.
 - iii. Defensive Action: Gain DT equal to all Stat Ranks added together
 - iv. Prepare an Action. The ability used will dictate AP and resource costs.
 - c. End Phase
 - i. Process end of turn triggers.
 - ii. The next character in initiative order starts their turn
 - d. Reactions
 - i. An action taken on another character's turn requiring preparation.
 1. Use DT to defend against incoming attacks.
 2. Trigger prepared actions. Examples include: Countering Abilities, Ambushes, Situational Healing.
3. End of Round.
 - a. Add 1 to the Round Counter.
 - b. Begin the next round starting with the highest initiative.

Combat Ends

1. When there are no hostile enemy targets remaining, combat ends.
 - a. If an enemy is temporarily incapacitated and becomes capable again, continue from the last round.
 - b. Think of combat as a time slice where seconds are measured. Outside of combat time can be handled more loosely.
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Actions

Generic Abilities:

The abilities may be used by any character without a skill granting them:

Move: 1 AP, 1 SP. Move Character Speed in spaces.

Unarmed Strike: 1 AP and 1 SP. Basic BDY roll attack. Modified by skills with no innate bonus.

Charge: 3 AP, 4 SP. Move Character Speed and use a melee attack ability.

Trip: 2 AP, 2 SP. BDY roll vs BDY roll. If an attacker is successful, the defender is prone.

Defender: 1AP, gain a DT for each Stat Rank (add them together)

Block (BDY): 1DT and 1SP per Stat Die Rolled. + Stat Rank Phys Resist.

Dodge (SPT): 1DT and 1SP per Stat Die Rolled. +Stat Rank Crit Range vs you, x2 Damage Value if hit.

Deflect (MND): 1ST and 1MP per Stat Die Rolled. +Stat Rank All Affinity Resist.

Moving

Additional moves in a turn cost the listed AP and the listed SP times the the number of Move actions taken this turn.

Attacking

Abilities: AP and HP, SP, or MP costs stated on ability.

Additional attacks in a turn cost the listed AP and the listed HP, SP, or MP stated on that ability times the number of Attack actions taken this turn.

Defending

Use any Defend Ability as a reaction.

The Stack

The Stack exists during an Action Phase. When an action is declared it is put on the Stack. When a reaction is declared it is placed on the stack above that action. Stack resolves from top to bottom. If multiple triggers would occur simultaneously, the owner decides the order.

Resolving Combat

Stat Roll Value = The resulting sum of a number of d6 die rolls equal to the governing Stat Rank.

Attack Value = Stat Roll Value + Attack Bonuses

Defense Value = Stat Roll Value + Defense Bonuses

Resolution Value = Attack Value - Defense Value

Critical Range Value = Default 10

Critical Damage Value = Default x2. Only applied to Resolution Value.

Damage Value = Resolution Value + Damage Modifiers

Once the Resolution Value is calculated determine if the Attack Hits.

Resolution Value ≥ 0 is a hit.

Resolution Value $\geq$ Critical Range Value is a Critical Hit.
Resolution Value $\leq$ Critical Range Value is a Critical Miss.

Critical Hits multiply the Resolution Value by Critical Damage Value before calculating the Damage Value. The Damage Value may represent multiple types of damage and should be applied separately. Multipliers to Damage Value types from other effects can be applied to each Damage Value. If multiple multipliers exist, subtract each by 1, then add 1 to the total or the remaining sums. Multiply the appropriate Damage Multipliers by their type before applying resistances. For each type subtract Character Resistances from corresponding Damage Value types, then the remaining Damage Values are subtracted from the target's current HP pool. For each type subtract Equipment Resistances from corresponding Damage Value types, then the remaining Damage Values are subtracted from the equipments HP pool. Equipment resistances are different from Character resistances. After HP pools are adjusted trigger any effects caused by the damage placing them on the stack in the order they trigger. Resolve the stack. This completes the Attack action.

Armor & Resistance

Physical Resistance

Phys Resist: Each instance of physical damage is reduced by this Value.
Piercing Resist: Pierce Damage is reduced by this Value.
Slashing Resist: Slash Damage is reduced by this Value.
Bashing Resist: Bash Damage is reduced by this Value.

Affinity Resistance

Affinity Resist: Each instance of Affinity damage is reduced by this Value.
Heat Resist: Heat Damage is reduced by this Value.
Cold Resist: Cold Damage is reduced by this Value.
Nature Resist: Nature Damage is reduced by this Value.
Psychic Resist: Psychic Damage is reduced by this Value.
Radiant Resist: Radiant Damage is reduced by this Value.
Shadow Resist: Shadow Damage is reduced by this Value.
Void Resist: Void Damage is reduced by this Value.
Aether Resist: Aether Damage is reduced by this Value.